him. The next individual to assume power was Otho. He is believed by his contemporaries to have been a good ruler. However, Vitellius sought his power and initiated a short civil war that resulted in Otho committing suicide. Thus, Vitellius effectively became the next emperor. However, Vitellius fared no better than Galba and ignored his responsibilities by spending extravagantly on feasts and entertainment. General Vespasian was encouraged by the Roman legions to march on Rome and assume power for himself. The legions assassinated Vitellius and Vespasian was declared emperor of Rome precisely one year after Galba had been declared emperor.

The period that followed the Year of the Four Emperors is known as the Flavian Dynasty. This era is recognized for its wealth, massive building projects and expansion of the empire's borders. Vespasian ruled for ten years and commissioned the construction of the great Coliseum. It took a very long time and was completed during the time of his son, Emperor Titus (79 – 81 CE). During Titus' reign, Mount Vesuvius erupted and covered Pompeii/Herculaneum under a thick blanket of ash for almost two thousand years. Titus is given considerable credit for dealing with the aftermath of this eruption and the Great Fire that occurred the following year in 80 CE. His brother Domitian succeeded Titus in 81 CE when he died from a fever. Domitian was another successful ruler who restored Rome from fire damage and stabilized the economy. While he was largely a good emperor, his tyrannical policies caused friction between himself and the Senate. He was eventually assassinated in 96 CE.